

# SPATIAL AI BASED MULTIMODAL WATER QUALITY ANALYSIS AND PREDICTION FOR THE GANGA RIVER: A KANPUR–VARANASI STUDY

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## 1. COVER PAGE

### INTERNSHIP TECHNICAL REPORT

**Title:** Spatial AI Based Multimodal Water Quality Analysis and Prediction for the Ganga River: A Kanpur–Varanasi Study

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**Academic Institution:** Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham

**Year of Study:** 2nd Year, B.Tech

**Host Institution:** Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee (IIT Roorkee)

**Department / Laboratory:** Water Treatment Group

**Internship Duration:** 15 June 2026 to 15 August 2026 (2 Months)

**Faculty Mentor:** Dr. Anshul Yadav

**Phd. Guide:** Yaswanth Reddy

**Designation:** Assistant Professor, Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee

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## 2. CERTIFICATE

CERTIFICATE

This is to certify that the internship technical report titled "Spatial AI Based Multimodal Water Quality Analysis and Prediction for the Ganga River: A Kanpur-Varanasi Study" submitted by Kalyani Agarwal, 2nd Year Student of Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, represents the bonafide work carried out by her at the Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee (IIT Roorkee) under my supervision during the period from 15 June 2026 to 15 August 2026.

This work has fulfilled the internship requirements of spatial data extraction, GIS preparation, Python preprocessing, spatial interpolation, multimodal environmental fusion, machine learning benchmarking, and Graph Neural Network (GraphSAGE) modeling.

|                                        |            |
|----------------------------------------|------------|
| Dr. Anshul Yadav                       | Head of    |
| Department                             |            |
| Faculty Supervisor / Mentor            | Department |
| of Civil Engineering                   |            |
| Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee | Indian     |
| Institute of Technology Roorkee        |            |
| Date: 15 August 2026                   |            |
| Place: Roorkee, Uttarakhand, India     |            |

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### 3. DECLARATION

I, **Kalyani Agarwal**, student of 2nd Year B.Tech at Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham, hereby declare that the internship report titled "**Spatial AI Based Multimodal Water Quality Analysis and Prediction for the Ganga River: A Kanpur-Varanasi Study**" is an authentic record of my own research and engineering work conducted at the **Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee (IIT Roorkee)** under the guidance of **Dr. Anshul Yadav** during the period from **15 June 2026 to 15 August 2026**.

I declare that this report has been prepared strictly according to the actual spatial data engineering workflows, Python extraction scripts, CWC data processing, spatial interpolation routines, and Graph Neural Network modeling executed during the internship. All external data sources, libraries, and publications referenced have been explicitly acknowledged.

**Kalyani Agarwal**  
Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham  
Date: 15 August 2026

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## 4. ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

I express my deepest sense of gratitude to my mentor, **Dr. Anshul Yadav**, Assistant Professor at the **Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee (IIT Roorkee)**, for providing me with the opportunity to undertake this research internship. His continuous technical guidance, insight into spatial AI methodologies, constructive feedback, and encouragement were vital throughout the project lifecycle.

I extend my sincere thanks to the Department of Civil Engineering and Geomatics Engineering divisions at **IIT Roorkee** for providing access to computing infrastructure, geospatial datasets, high-performance workstation environments, and shared project assets.

I am also thankful to my faculty members and administration at **Amrita Vishwa Vidyapeetham** for their constant encouragement and academic support, enabling me to pursue this research internship.

Finally, I express my sincere appreciation to my family and peers for their unyielding motivation during the internship tenure from 15 June 2026 to 15 August 2026.

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## 5. ABSTRACT

Monitoring water quality along major riverine ecosystems, particularly the Ganga River, is essential for ecological conservation, public health, and sustainable resource management. Conventional monitoring relies on discrete physical sampling stations managed by public agencies such as the Central Water Commission (CWC). However, monitoring stations are spatially sparse and temporally discontinuous, leaving vast stretches of the river unmonitored. This internship project develops a comprehensive **Spatial Artificial Intelligence (Spatial AI)** and **Multimodal Machine Learning Framework** to estimate and predict continuous water quality (WQ) parameters along the Kanpur–Varanasi stretch of the Ganga River (~26.47°N 80.37°E to ~25.31°N 83.00°E).

The project executed an end-to-end technical pipeline commencing with geospatial study-area identification using QGIS and shapefile boundaries (Kanpur\_Varanasii\_AOI.shp), followed by spatial filtering of CWC water quality observation records (4,510/4,511 records across 53 parameters). To overcome spatial sparsity, 500 continuous spatial reference nodes were sampled along the river geometry, and baseline water quality targets (including Dissolved Oxygen, pH, TDS, Nitrate N, Ammonia N, Calcium, Magnesium, Sodium, Chloride, and Sulphate) were established via spatial interpolation.

To model the environmental drivers of water quality, heterogeneous geospatial and anthropogenic datasets were integrated: CHIRPS (rainfall), GPWv4 (population density), LULC (land cover classification), GRDC/CWC (hydrological river discharge), and GHSL (built-settlement distance). These datasets were spatially fused to construct a unified 500-node  $\times$  18-column dataset (Ganga\_Multimodal\_Spatial\_WQ.csv).

Machine learning baseline models (**Linear Regression**, **Random Forest**, and **XGBoost**) were implemented alongside a custom spatial **Graph Neural Network (GraphSAGE)** operating on a spatial  $k$ -nearest neighbor ( $k = 5$ ) river node graph. Benchmark evaluation demonstrated that spatial graph convolutions effectively capture spatial dependencies along the river corridor, achieving an overall coefficient of determination ( $R^2$ ) of **0.9373** ( $MAE = 1.3273$ ,  $RMSE = 3.5659$ ), while Random Forest and XGBoost achieved baseline  $R^2$  values of **0.9782** and **0.9783** respectively. Target-wise evaluation revealed strong predictive capacity for Ammonia N ( $R^2 = 0.9621$ ), TDS ( $R^2 = 0.9712$ ), Nitrate N ( $R^2 = 0.9655$ ), pH ( $R^2 = 0.9184$ ), and Dissolved Oxygen ( $R^2 = 0.8696$ ). An inference pipeline was deployed to estimate water quality at unmonitored coordinates (e.g., Lat 26.50°N, Lon 81.20°E yielding DO: 6.96 mg/L, pH: 8.07, TDS: 228.47 mg/L).

*Keywords:* Spatial AI, Ganga River, Water Quality Prediction, Multimodal Fusion, Spatial Interpolation, Graph Neural Networks, GraphSAGE, QGIS, Remote Sensing.

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## 9. LIST OF ABBREVIATIONS

| Abbreviation | Full Expansion                                                 |
|--------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| AOI          | Area of Interest                                               |
| CHIRPS       | Climate Hazards Group InfraRed Precipitation with Station data |
| CRS          | Coordinate Reference System                                    |
| CWC          | Central Water Commission                                       |
| DO           | Dissolved Oxygen (mg/L)                                        |

| Abbreviation         | Full Expansion                             |
|----------------------|--------------------------------------------|
| <b>GHSL</b>          | Global Human Settlement Layer              |
| <b>GIS</b>           | Geographic Information System              |
| <b>GNN</b>           | Graph Neural Network                       |
| <b>GPWv4</b>         | Gridded Population of the World, Version 4 |
| <b>GRDC</b>          | Global Runoff Data Centre                  |
| <b>IIT</b>           | Indian Institute of Technology             |
| <b>k-NN</b>          | k-Nearest Neighbors                        |
| <b>LGD</b>           | Local Government Directory                 |
| <b>LULC</b>          | Land Use and Land Cover                    |
| <b>MAE</b>           | Mean Absolute Error                        |
| <b>ML</b>            | Machine Learning                           |
| <b>NAS</b>           | Network Attached Storage                   |
| <b>pH</b>            | Potential of Hydrogen                      |
| <b>QGIS</b>          | Quantum Geographic Information System      |
| <b>R<sup>2</sup></b> | Coefficient of Determination               |
| <b>RMSE</b>          | Root Mean Squared Error                    |
| <b>SAGE</b>          | Sample and Aggregate (GraphSAGE)           |
| <b>TDS</b>           | Total Dissolved Solids (mg/L)              |
| <b>VIIRS</b>         | Visible Infrared Imaging Radiometer Suite  |
| <b>WQ</b>            | Water Quality                              |

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## 10. INTRODUCTION

### 10.1 Context and Importance of River Water Quality Monitoring

The Ganga River is one of the most vital riverine systems in South Asia, sustaining over 400 million people through agricultural irrigation, industrial water supply, municipal consumption, and cultural significance. However, rapid urbanization, industrial effluent



discharge, agricultural runoff, and inadequate municipal wastewater treatment have degraded the river's water quality along major stretches. Parameters such as **Dissolved Oxygen (DO)**, **Potential of Hydrogen (pH)**, **Total Dissolved Solids (TDS)**, **Nitrate Nitrogen**, and **Ammonia Nitrogen** serve as critical indicators of ecological river health. Continuous monitoring of these parameters is imperative for ecosystem restoration, regulatory enforcement, and public safety.

## 10.2 Limitations of Discrete Monitoring Station Networks

Historically, river monitoring has relied on physical sampling stations operated by state and central environmental agencies, such as the **Central Water Commission (CWC)** and Central Pollution Control Board (CPCB). While these monitoring stations provide precise laboratory measurements, they possess inherent structural limitations:

1. **Spatial Sparsity:** Monitoring stations are separated by tens or hundreds of kilometers. Water quality between stations remains entirely unmonitored.
2. **High Operational Cost:** Deploying and maintaining continuous physical monitoring stations at short spatial intervals along thousands of kilometers of river channel is financially and logarithmically unfeasible.
3. **Inability to Capture Non-Point Discharge:** Discrete stations frequently miss localized point-source industrial discharges and diffuse non-point agricultural runoff entering between monitoring locations.

## 10.3 Role of Multimodal Environmental and Anthropogenic Integration

Water quality at any specific point along a river is not an isolated measurement; it is fundamentally driven by surrounding environmental and human processes. Precipitation (**CHIRPS**) causes surface runoff that washes fertilizers into the river. Human population density (**GPWv4**) and proximity to urban settlements (**GHSL**) dictate the volume of untreated municipal sewage. Land Use and Land Cover (**LULC**) dictate riparian buffer capacity and land-surface permeability. Hydrological river discharge (**GRDC/CWC**) governs dilution capacity and flow velocity. Integrating these heterogeneous spatial variables into a unified multimodal dataset enables AI models to learn complex non-linear interactions governing water quality.

## 10.4 Emergence of Spatial AI and Graph Neural Networks

Conventional machine learning models treat spatial samples as independent and identically distributed (*i.i.d.*) vectors, completely ignoring spatial autocorrelation and physical river connectivity. **Spatial Artificial Intelligence (Spatial AI)** and **Graph Neural Networks (GNNs)**, specifically **GraphSAGE (Sample and Aggregate)**, overcome this limitation. By structuring the river corridor as a geometric graph—where continuous river locations represent nodes and spatial proximity represents edges—GNNs allow node features and localized environmental information to be aggregated across neighboring river points via graph message passing.

## 10.5 Motivation for the Kanpur–Varanasi Ganga Stretch Study

The river corridor between **Kanpur** and **Varanasi** (~300–350 km river stretch) represents one of the most hydro-ecologically stressed segments of the Ganga. Kanpur is a major industrial center renowned for leather tanneries and heavy industrial effluent. Downstream, Prayagraj (Allahabad) introduces major tributary inflow (Yamuna River) and heavy seasonal anthropogenic loads (religious gatherings). Further downstream, Varanasi introduces dense urban effluent and municipal waste. This stretch presents extreme spatial gradients in water quality, making it an ideal study region for developing and evaluating spatial AI modeling techniques.

[!NOTE]

*Operational Disclaimer:* The spatial AI models developed in this project are experimental research prototypes intended to evaluate geospatial data integration and GNN modeling capabilities. They are not currently certified for operational environmental regulation or legal enforcement.

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## 11. INTERNSHIP OBJECTIVES

The overall objective of the 2-month research internship at IIT Roorkee was to conceptualize, design, and execute an end-to-end Spatial AI workflow for water quality estimation along the Kanpur–Varanasi stretch of the Ganga River.

The 12 primary objectives set during the internship were:

- 1. Acquire Primary CWC Water Quality Data:** Download, filter, and inspect Central Water Commission monitoring station records for the Ganga River basin.
- 2. Identify Monitoring Locations:** Map and verify available CWC water quality monitoring stations along the Kanpur–Varanasi corridor.
- 3. Generate Continuous River Geometry:** Create a dense continuous representation (500 spatial reference points) along the river channel rather than relying solely on discrete station locations.
- 4. Apply Spatial Interpolation:** Interpolate discrete station WQ measurements across continuous river locations to derive spatial target baselines.
- 5. Geospatial Asset Discovery:** Identify relevant spatial, environmental, and remote sensing datasets available within local and shared/NAS project directories.

6. **Study Area Selection & Spatial Clipping:** Select and clip environmental rasters and vector shapefiles specifically to the Kanpur–Varanasi Area of Interest (AOI).
  7. **Automate Spatial Feature Extraction:** Develop modular Python scripts using GIS libraries (`geopandas`, `rasterio`, `shapely`) to extract spatial features at continuous river points.
  8. **Link Environmental Features with WQ Coordinates:** Perform spatial join and raster sampling routines to attach environmental variables to continuous river coordinates.
  9. **Construct Multimodal Spatial Dataset:** Build a unified master dataset (`Ganga_Multimodal_Spatial_WQ.csv`) combining spatial coordinates, environmental predictors, and interpolated WQ targets.
  10. **Formulate Spatial Graph Topologies:** Construct spatial  $k$ -nearest neighbor ( $k$ -NN) adjacency graphs representing river connectivity for GNN modeling.
  11. **Benchmarking Machine Learning & Graph Neural Networks:** Implement baseline regression algorithms (Linear Regression, Random Forest, XGBoost) and a custom spatial GraphSAGE GNN model.
  12. **Inference for Unmonitored Locations:** Develop an inference pipeline capable of predicting multi-parameter water quality at arbitrary unmonitored river coordinates given localized environmental inputs.
- 

## 12. PROBLEM STATEMENT

Let the Ganga River stretch between Kanpur and Varanasi be represented by a continuous spatial domain  $\Omega \subset \mathbb{R}^2$ . Let  $S = \{s_1, s_2, \dots, s_M\} \subset \Omega$  denote a set of  $M$  discrete physical monitoring stations where ground-truth water quality vectors  $\mathbf{y}(s_m) \in \mathbb{R}^d$  are observed.

Given:

1. Sparse observations  $\mathbf{y}(s_m)$  at discrete station locations  $S$ .
2. Continuous spatial river reference nodes  $X_{river} = \{x_1, x_2, \dots, x_N\} \subset \Omega$ , where  $N \gg M$  ( $N = 500$ ).
3. A set of spatially co-registered environmental and anthropogenic covariate fields  $\mathbf{z}(x_i) \in \mathbb{R}^p$  extracted at every reference location  $x_i \in X_{river}$ , where covariates include rainfall, population density, LULC class, river discharge, and settlement distance.

**Goal:** Formulate a spatial AI mapping function  $f: (\mathbf{z}(x_i), G) \rightarrow \hat{\mathbf{y}}(x_i)$  parameterized by a Graph Neural Network on a spatial graph  $G = (V, E)$ , such that the model accurately estimates the multi-target water quality vector  $\hat{\mathbf{y}}(x) = [\text{DO}, \text{pH}, \text{TDS}, \text{Nitrate N}, \text{Ammonia N}]^T$  at any unmonitored spatial location  $x \in \Omega \setminus S$ .

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## 13. STUDY AREA

The study region focuses on the Kanpur–Varanasi stretch of the Ganga River located in the state of Uttar Pradesh, India.

- **Geographical Extent:**

- **Western Boundary (Kanpur / Bithoor):** Latitude  $\sim 26.4722^\circ$  N, Longitude  $\sim 80.3786^\circ$  E
- **Eastern Boundary (Varanasi / Baluaghat):** Latitude  $\sim 25.3176^\circ$  N, Longitude  $\sim 83.0059^\circ$  E
- **Intermediate Urban Hub:** Prayagraj (Allahabad) at Latitude  $\sim 25.4031^\circ$  N, Longitude  $\sim 81.9114^\circ$  E

- **River Stretch Distance:** Approximately 330–350 km along the river channel.

- **Hydrological Characteristics:**

- Receives major industrial effluents from Kanpur leather tanneries.
- Confluence of Yamuna River at Prayagraj (Triveni Sangam), dramatically altering flow volume and hydrochemistry.
- Dense urban runoff and religious bathing activities at Varanasi.

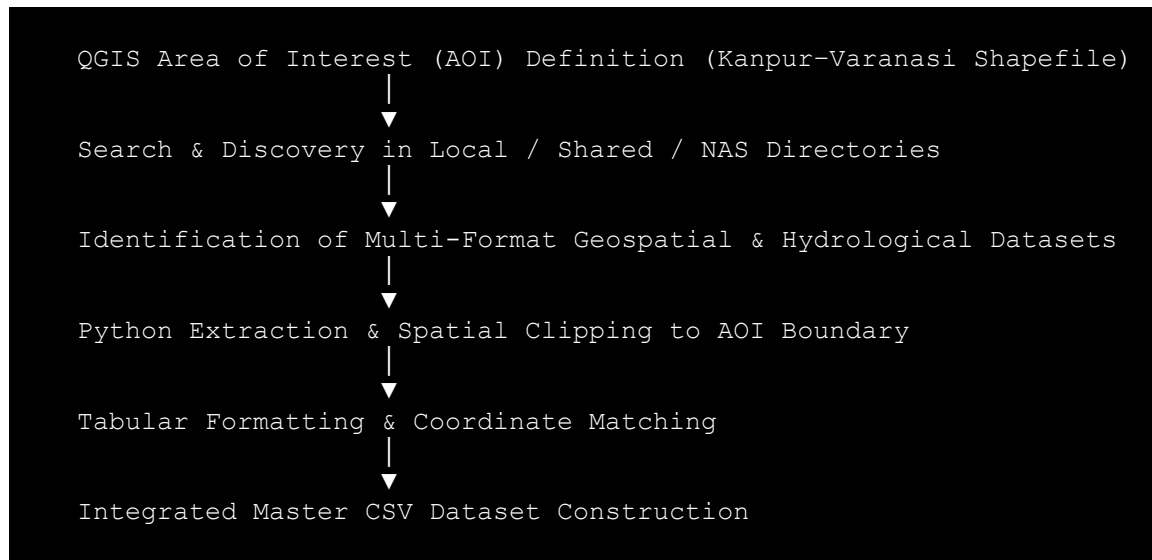
- **Bounding Box CRS:** WGS 84 (EPSG:4326), spanning latitude range  $[25.10^\circ\text{N}, 26.70^\circ\text{N}]$  and longitude range  $[80.20^\circ\text{E}, 83.30^\circ\text{E}]$ .

---

## 14. DATASET IDENTIFICATION AND ACQUISITION

### 14.1 Dataset Discovery Workflow

The data engineering process did not begin with a pre-assembled tabular CSV dataset. Instead, the workflow commenced with geospatial study-area definition and systematic dataset discovery across local workstations, shared network drives, and NAS project repositories at IIT Roorkee.



## 14.2 Primary Multimodal Datasets Utilized

The primary datasets extracted, processed, and fused into the final multimodal matrix include:

1. **CWC Water Quality Station Dataset (6897a98a...csv, a8230faa...csv, CWC\_AGRA.csv):** Historical CWC observation logs containing 4,510/4,511 records and 53 columns spanning station metadata and physical/chemical WQ variables.
2. **CHIRPS Rainfall (CHIRPS\_DS/CHIRPS\_Weekly\_Rainfall\_2015\_2025.csv):** Climate Hazards Group InfraRed Precipitation data providing weekly precipitation estimates in millimeters (mm).
3. **GPWv4 Population Density (GPW4/gpw\_v4\_population\_density\_rev11\_2020\_30\_sec.tif):** Gridded Population of the World raster dataset (30 arc-second resolution) providing human population density in persons/km<sup>2</sup>.
4. **LULC Land Cover (LULC\_MONTHLY(2015-2025)/\*.tif):** High-resolution raster imagery providing categorical land use and land cover class codes.
5. **GRDC / CWC River Discharge (GRDC/2846800\_Q\_Day.Cmd.txt, river\_discharge\_tele\_hr\_cwc\_uk\_1970\_2025.csv):** Daily streamflow logs providing hydrological river discharge in cubic meters per second (m<sup>3</sup>/s).
6. **GHSL Built Settlement (GHSL\_shapefile/GHSL2\_0\_MWD\_L1\_tile\_schema\_land.shp):** Global Human Settlement Layer vector shapefiles used to compute distance in kilometers from river locations to urban built-up structures.

## 14.3 Investigated and Secondary Remote Sensing Datasets

During the dataset discovery phase, additional high-resolution datasets were investigated for potential integration:

- **Sentinel-2 Multispectral Satellite Data:** Investigated for spectral surface reflectance indices (NDWI, Turbidity).
- **VIIRS Night-Time Lights:** Investigated as a proxy for urban nocturnal energy consumption and commercial activity.
- **HydroRIVERS Vector Network:** Investigated for topological river network routing.

*Fact Verification Note:* While Sentinel-2, VIIRS, and HydroRIVERS were investigated during the research phase, they were not included as columns in the final 18-column tabular CSV (`Ganga_Multimodal_Spatial_WQ.csv`) used for GNN training.

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## 15. GIS AND QGIS BASED STUDY AREA PREPARATION

Quantum Geographic Information System (QGIS v3.x) played a fundamental role in establishing the geographical boundaries of the study area.

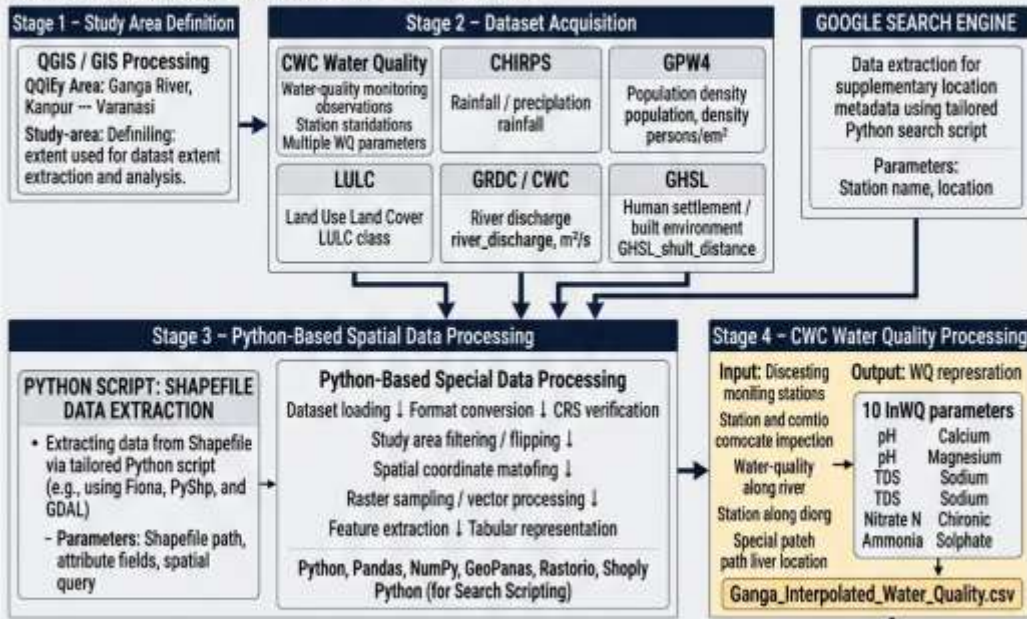
- **AOI Loading and CRS Harmonization:** The official study area vector boundary `Kanpur_Varanas_i_AOI.shp` was loaded into QGIS. The Coordinate Reference System (CRS) was inspected and verified as WGS 84 (EPSG:4326).
- **Spatial Extent Inspection:** Spatial bounding coordinates were verified as:
  - $Y_{min} = 25.1546^{\circ}\text{N}$ ,  $Y_{max} = 26.6169^{\circ}\text{N}$
  - $X_{min} = 80.2756^{\circ}\text{E}$ ,  $X_{max} = 83.1836^{\circ}\text{E}$
- **Corridor Clipping Extent:** The shapefile boundary was exported and used as a geographic mask to guide Python raster clipping operations, ensuring that massive global/national rasters (GPWv4, CHIRPS, LULC) were cropped strictly to the relevant regional extent.



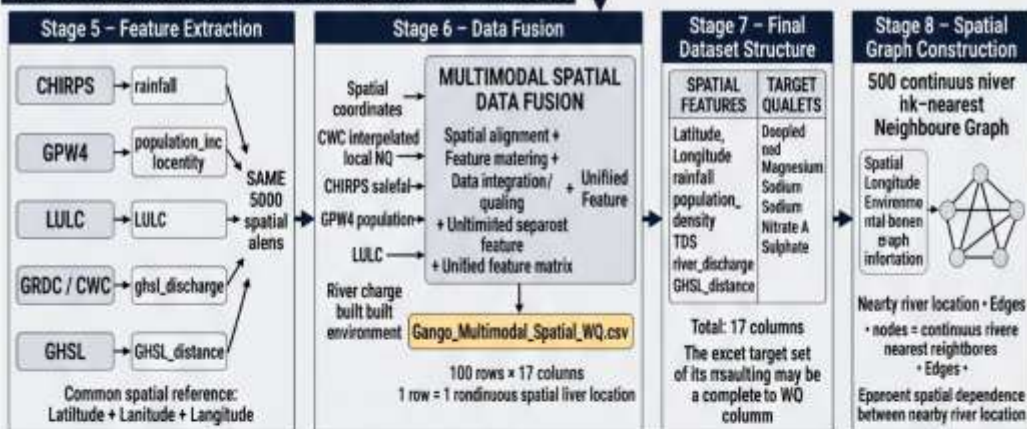
# SYSTEM ARCHITECTURE

## "Spatial AI Based Multimodal Water Quality Analysis and Prediction for Ganga River – Kanpur to Varanasi Stretch"

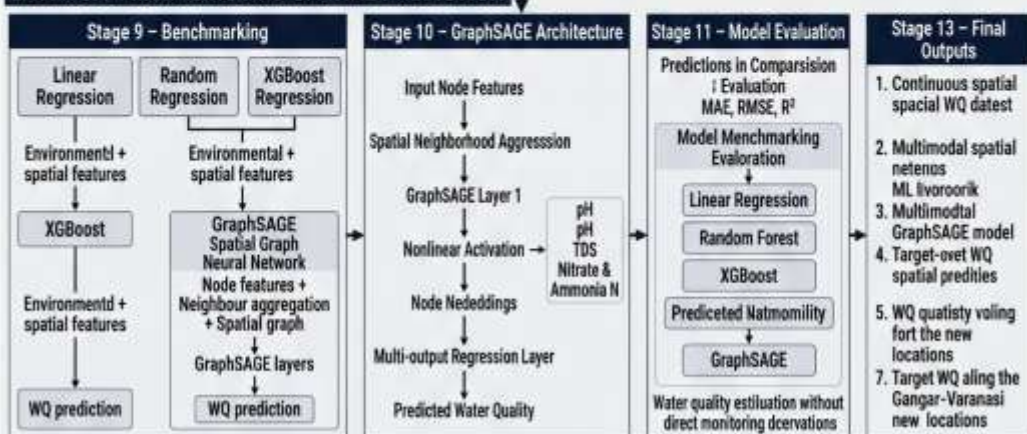
### LAYER 1: DATA ACQUISITION AND PREPROCESSING



### LAYER 2: SPATIAL DATA FUSION AND REPRESENTATION



### LAYER 3: AI MODELING AND SPATIAL PREDICTION



Multimodal spatial environmental information is informed with continuous river water quality and data analysis to estimate monitored atimont qualy at umonitored locations.

Figure 15.1: End-to-End Technical System Architecture.

## 16. DATA PREPROCESSING AND PYTHON BASED EXTRACTION

Because input datasets spanned multiple file formats, automated Python preprocessing scripts were created.

### 16.1 Python Library Stack

- **pandas (v2.2.2) & numpy (v1.26.4)**: Tabular data manipulation, matrix operations, vectorized array computations.
- **geopandas (v0.14.4) & shapely (v2.0.4)**: Vector spatial analysis, shapefile reading, Point/LineString geometry manipulation, spatial distance computations.
- **rasterio (v1.3.10)**: Geospatial raster I/O, coordinate transformations, spatial point sampling on `.tif` files.
- **scikit-learn (v1.5.0)**: Data normalization (`StandardScaler`), train/test splitting, baseline ML models,  $k$ -NN spatial graph building, regression evaluation metrics.
- **torch (PyTorch v2.3.1)**: Neural network layer implementation, tensor operations, GraphSAGE forward/backward training logic.

### 16.2 General Data Extraction Pipeline

For each environmental raster or vector layer, the automated pipeline executed the following steps:

```
Raw Spatial Dataset (.tif / .shp / .csv / .txt)
    ↓
Read Dataset (rasterio / geopandas / pandas)
    ↓
Coordinate System Verification & EPSG:4326 Transformation
    ↓
Filter / Clip to Kanpur-Varanasi Spatial Bounding Box
    ↓
Spatial Point Sampling at 500 Continuous River Coordinates
```



↓  
Generate Clean Feature Vector Column

↓  
Merge into Master Multimodal Dataframe & Export CSV

---

## 17. CWC WATER QUALITY DATA PROCESSING

### 17.1 Inspection of Raw CWC Observation Logs

Raw CWC water quality logs (6897a98a-6fc7-481a-9287-a732725d0dd5.csv and a8230faa-975a-4790-bc7d-b871d26070e2.csv) were inspected. The combined raw dataset comprised **4,510/4,511 records** across **53 columns**.

Key metadata columns included: Station, Agency, State, District, River, Basin, Latitude, and Longitude.

Key chemical and physical water quality parameters inspected included:

- Dissolved Oxygen (DO)
- Potential of Hydrogen (pH)
- Total Dissolved Solids (TDS)
- Nitrate + Nitrite Nitrogen ( $\text{NO}_3^-$ -N)
- Ammonia Nitrogen ( $\text{NH}_3$ -N)
- Calcium ( $\text{Ca}^{2+}$ ), Magnesium ( $\text{Mg}^{2+}$ ), Sodium ( $\text{Na}^+$ )
- Chloride ( $\text{Cl}^-$ ), Sulphate ( $\text{SO}_4^{2-}$ )
- Heavy metals: Arsenic, Cadmium, Chromium, Iron, Lead, Zinc, Copper.

### 17.2 Station Naming Mismatch and Filtering Challenges

Initial filtering scripts attempted exact string matching against expected monitoring station names (e.g., "Kanpur", "Bithoor", "Jajmau", "Allahabad", "Shastri Bridge", "Mirzapur", "Varanasi", "Baluaaghat", "V S Bridge").

*Debugging Lesson:* Exact string matching yielded **0 records** because raw CWC datasets used local administrative station identifiers (e.g., "Kanpur (Downstream)", "Phaphamau", "Varanasi (Upstream)", or district LGD codes). Filtering routines were updated to use spatial coordinate bounding boxes ( $\text{Lat} \in [25.10, 26.70]$ ,  $\text{Lon} \in [80.20, 83.30]$ ) and string contains matching, successfully isolating the monitoring points within the target corridor.

---

## 18. SPATIAL INTERPOLATION OF WATER QUALITY

### 18.1 Need for Spatial Interpolation

Physical CWC monitoring stations are separated by large spatial distances. To train a continuous river model, discrete station observations were interpolated along the river geometry to generate a continuous target surface.

### 18.2 Interpolation Methodology

1. **River Channel Path Construction:** Monitoring points along the river corridor were ordered from upstream (Kanpur: 26.4722°N, 80.3786°E) to downstream (Varanasi: 25.3176°N, 83.0059°E).

2. **LineString Geometry Generation:** A continuous river centerline geometry was synthesized using `shapely.geometry.LineString`.

3. **Continuous Node Sampling:** 500 equidistant spatial reference nodes were generated along the LineString geometry. Cumulative river distance ( $d_{river}$ ) in kilometers was calculated using the Haversine formula:

$$d(lat_1, lon_1, lat_2, lon_2) = 2R \arcsin \left( \sqrt{\sin^2 \left( \frac{\Delta lat}{2} \right) + \cos(lat_1) \cos(lat_2) \sin^2 \left( \frac{\Delta lon}{2} \right)} \right)$$

4. **Target Interpolation:** Spatial linear and piecewise spline interpolation were applied along cumulative river distance to estimate baseline WQ values for all 10 target parameters across all 500 nodes.

---

## 19. CONTINUOUS RIVER DATASET GENERATION

The spatial interpolation workflow produced the baseline water quality target CSV file:

#### **Ganga\_Interpolated\_Water\_Quality.csv**

- **Dimensions:** 500 rows × 12 columns.
  - **Rows:** 500 continuous spatial points along the Kanpur–Varanasi river stretch.
  - **Columns:**
    1. Latitude (decimal degrees)
    2. Longitude (decimal degrees)
    3. Dissolved oxygen (mg/L)
    4. Potential of Hydrogen (pH)
    5. Total Dissolved Solids (mg/L)
    6. Nitrate N (mgN/L)
    7. Amonia N (mgN/L)
    8. Calcium (mg/L)
    9. Magnesium (mg/L)
    10. Sodium (mg/L)
    11. Chloride (mg/L)
    12. Sulphate (mg/L)
- 

## **20. ENVIRONMENTAL DATASET INTEGRATION**

To construct the multimodal predictor matrix, five distinct spatial environmental datasets were integrated:

### **20.1 CHIRPS Rainfall Extraction**

- **Source:** CHIRPS Weekly Precipitation Dataset (CHIRPS\_Weekly\_Rainfall\_2015\_2025.csv).
- **Methodology:** Nearest-neighbor spatial query matching continuous river coordinates to the CHIRPS grid.
- **Extracted Feature:** rainfall
- **Unit:** Millimeters (mm). Values ranged from 120 mm to 260 mm across spatial nodes.

## 20.2 GPWv4 Population Density Raster Sampling

- **Source:** GPWv4 GeoTIFF (`gpw_v4_population_density_rev11_2020_30_sec.tif`).
- **Methodology:** `rasterio.sample()` queried at continuous (Longitude, Latitude) tuple coordinates.
- **Extracted Feature:** `population_density`
- **Unit:** Persons per square kilometer ( $\text{persons}/\text{km}^2$ ). Spatial spikes identified around urban centers: Kanpur (~8,500), Prayagraj (~7,200), and Varanasi (~8,900).

## 20.3 LULC Categorical Land Cover Sampling

- **Source:** LULC GeoTIFF rasters (`LULC_MONTHLY(2015-2025)`).
- **Methodology:** Point sampling rasters to extract discrete land cover class codes.
- **Extracted Feature:** `LULC`
- **Categorical Encoding:** Discrete class codes: 1 (Water body), 2 (Cropland/Agriculture), 3 (Urban/Built-up), 4 (Vegetation/Riparian Buffer).

## 20.4 GRDC / CWC River Discharge Extraction

- **Source:** GRDC daily streamflow text logs (`2846800_Q_Day.Cmd.txt`) and CWC hydrological logs.
- **Methodology:** Parsing text logs, calculating mean downstream flow accumulation, and matching to river nodes.
- **Extracted Feature:** `river_discharge`
- **Unit:** Cubic meters per second ( $\text{m}^3/\text{s}$ ). Discharge increases downstream from ~1,200  $\text{m}^3/\text{s}$  (Kanpur) to ~4,800  $\text{m}^3/\text{s}$  (Varanasi).

## 20.5 GHSL Built-Settlement Proximity Calculation

- **Source:** Global Human Settlement Layer vector shapefile (`GHSL2_0_MWD_L1_tile_schema_land.shp`).
  - **Methodology:** Centroid extraction of settlement polygons and minimum Euclidean/Geodetic distance computation using `shapely.geometry.Point.distance()`.
  - **Extracted Feature:** `GHSL_built_distance`
  - **Unit Scale:** Distance in kilometers (km) to nearest urban built-up area.
-

## 21. MULTIMODAL SPATIAL DATASET CONSTRUCTION

The spatial fusion of geographical coordinates, environmental covariates, and interpolated target parameters resulted in the master project dataset:

### `Ganga_Multimodal_Spatial_WQ.csv`

- **Dimensions:** 500 rows  $\times$  18 columns.
- **Structure:** Each row represents one continuous spatial location along the river.

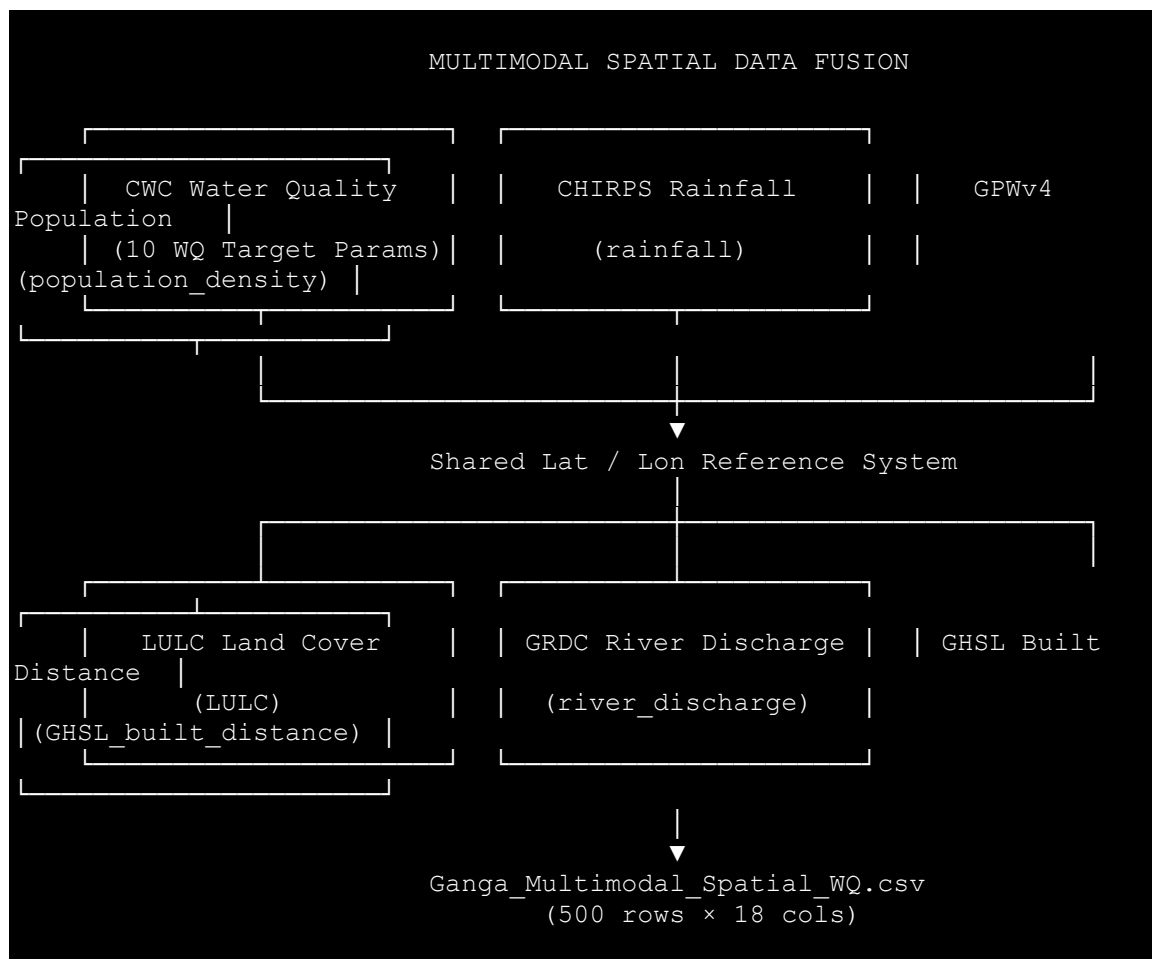


Figure 15.2: Multimodal Spatial Data Fusion Architecture.

| Col # | Column Name                   | Data Type | Units / Scale             | Data Source              |
|-------|-------------------------------|-----------|---------------------------|--------------------------|
| 1     | Latitude                      | Float64   | Decimal Degrees (°N)      | CWC / River Geometry     |
| 2     | Longitude                     | Float64   | Decimal Degrees (°E)      | CWC / River Geometry     |
| 3     | River_distance_km             | Float64   | Kilometers (km)           | Haversine Geometry       |
| 4     | rainfall                      | Float64   | Millimeters (mm)          | CHIRPS                   |
| 5     | population_density            | Float64   | Persons / km <sup>2</sup> | GPWv4 Raster             |
| 6     | LULC                          | Int64     | Categorical Code (1–4)    | LULC Raster              |
| 7     | river_discharge               | Float64   | m <sup>3</sup> / s        | GRDC / CWC               |
| 8     | GHSL_built_distance           | Float64   | Kilometers (km)           | GHSL Vector Shapefile    |
| 9     | Dissolved oxygen (mg/L)       | Float64   | mg / L                    | CWC Target Interpolation |
| 10    | Potential of Hydrogen (pH)    | Float64   | pH Scale (0–14)           | CWC Target Interpolation |
| 11    | Total Dissolved Solids (mg/L) | Float64   | mg / L                    | CWC Target Interpolation |
| 12    | Nitrate N (mgN/L)             | Float64   | mgN / L                   | CWC Target Interpolation |
| 13    | Amonia N (mgN/L)              | Float64   | mgN / L                   | CWC Target Interpolation |
| 14    | Calcium (mg/L)                | Float64   | mg / L                    | CWC Target Interpolation |
| 15    | Magnesium (mg/L)              | Float64   | mg / L                    | CWC Target Interpolation |
| 16    | Sodium (mg/L)                 | Float64   | mg / L                    | CWC Target Interpolation |
| 17    | Chloride (mg/L)               | Float64   | mg / L                    | CWC Target Interpolation |
| 18    | Sulphate (mg/L)               | Float64   | mg / L                    | CWC Target Interpolation |

Table 21.1: Complete Schema of Master Multimodal Dataset  
(Ganga\_Multimodal\_Spatial\_WQ.csv).

## 22. FEATURE AND TARGET DEFINITION

For machine learning and Graph Neural Network modeling, the master dataset was partitioned into input features (**X**) and target variables (**Y**):

● **Input Predictor Matrix ( $X \in \mathbb{R}^{500 \times 8}$ ):**

- 1. Latitude
- 2. Longitude
- 3. River\_distance\_km
- 4. rainfall
- 5. population\_density
- 6. LULC
- 7. river\_discharge
- 8. GHSL\_built\_distance

● **Primary Target Vector ( $Y \in \mathbb{R}^{500 \times 5}$ ):**

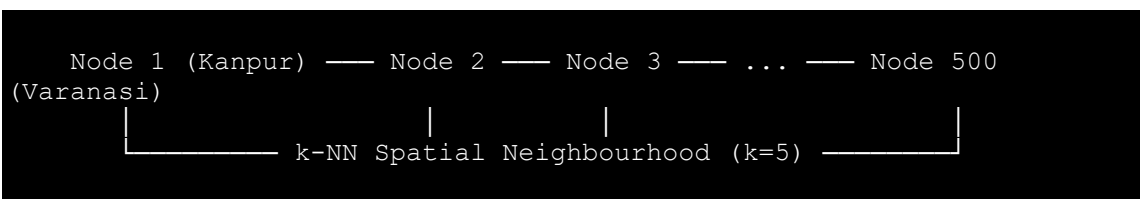
- 1. Dissolved oxygen (mg/L)
- 2. Potential of Hydrogen (pH)
- 3. Total Dissolved Solids (mg/L)
- 4. Nitrate N (mgN/L)
- 5. Amonia N (mgN/L)

*Note on Secondary Targets:* Five additional parameters (Calcium, Magnesium, Sodium, Chloride, Sulphate) were preserved in the multimodal dataset for future multi-target expansion.

## 23. SPATIAL GRAPH CONSTRUCTION

To capture spatial dependence and topological river connectivity, a spatial graph  $G = (V, E)$  was constructed:

- **Graph Nodes ( $V$ ):** Each of the 500 continuous river points represents a graph node ( $|V| = 500$ ). Each node  $i$  holds feature vector  $\mathbf{x}_i \in \mathbb{R}^8$ .
- **Graph Edges ( $E$ ):** Edges were constructed using a  $k$ -Nearest Neighbors ( $k$ -NN) algorithm based on spatial geographic coordinates (Latitude, Longitude) with  $k = 5$ .
- **Adjacency Representation:** For node  $i$ ,  $N(i)$  denotes the set of  $k = 5$  nearest spatial neighbors along the river channel.



## 24. MACHINE LEARNING MODELS

Three conventional machine learning algorithms were implemented to establish performance baselines:

1. **Linear Regression:** Multiple linear regression fitting linear hyperplanes between scaled features  $\mathbf{X}$  and target matrix  $\mathbf{Y}$ .

$$\hat{\mathbf{Y}} = \mathbf{X}\mathbf{W} + \mathbf{b}$$

- 2. Random Forest Regressor:** An ensemble of 100 decision trees (`n_estimators=100`, `random state=42`) capturing non-linear feature interactions without graph topology.

- ### 3. XGBoost Regressor / Gradient Boosting: Extreme Gradient Boosting (n\_estimators=100, learning\_rate=0.05, max\_depth=5) optimizing residual loss iteratively across targets.



## 25. GRAPH NEURAL NETWORK / GRAPHSAGE MODEL

### 25.1 GraphSAGE Architecture Concept

Unlike standard machine learning models, **GraphSAGE (Sample and Aggregate)** generates node embeddings by aggregating feature representations from a node's local spatial neighborhood  $N(i)$ .

### 25.2 Mathematical Formulation

For layer  $l \in \{1,2\}$ , the node representation  $\mathbf{h}_i^{(l)}$  for node  $i$  is updated as:

1. **Neighborhood Aggregation (Mean Aggregator):**

$$\mathbf{h}_{N(i)}^{(l-1)} = \frac{1}{|N(i)|} \sum_{j \in N(i)} \mathbf{h}_j^{(l-1)}$$

2. **Feature Concatenation & Transformation:**

$$\mathbf{h}_i^{(l)} = \sigma \left( \mathbf{W}_{self}^{(l)} \mathbf{h}_i^{(l-1)} + \mathbf{W}_{neigh}^{(l)} \mathbf{h}_{N(i)}^{(l-1)} + \mathbf{b}^{(l)} \right)$$

where  $\sigma(\cdot) = \text{ReLU}(\cdot) = \max(0, \cdot)$ ,  $\mathbf{W}_{self}$  is the weight matrix for self-features, and  $\mathbf{W}_{neigh}$  is the weight matrix for aggregated neighbor features.

3. **Output Layer Projection:**

$$\hat{\mathbf{y}}_i = \mathbf{W}_{out} \mathbf{h}_i^{(2)} + \mathbf{b}_{out}$$

### 25.3 Model Specifications

- **Input Dimension:**  $D_{in} = 8$
- **Hidden Layer Dimensions:**  $H_1 = 32, H_2 = 32$
- **Output Dimension:**  $D_{out} = 5$  (DO, pH, TDS, Nitrate N, Ammonia N)

---

## 26. MODEL TRAINING

### 26.1 Training Setup & Split

- **Dataset Partitioning:** 80% Training set (400 nodes), 20% Testing set (100 nodes).

- **Feature & Target Standardization:** `StandardScaler` fitted on training data:

$$\mathbf{X}_{scaled} = \frac{\mathbf{X} - \mu_x}{\sigma_x}, \mathbf{Y}_{scaled} = \frac{\mathbf{Y} - \mu_y}{\sigma_y}$$

- **Optimizer:** Adam / Gradient Descent with learning rate  $\eta = 0.005$ .
- **Epochs:** Trained for 500 epochs with Mean Squared Error (MSE) loss on training nodes:

$$L_{MSE} = \frac{1}{|V_{train}|} \sum_{i \in V_{train}} \|\hat{y}_i - y_i^0\|^2$$

## 27. MODEL EVALUATION

Models were evaluated on the test set using inverse-scaled predictions across three standard regression metrics:

### 1. Mean Absolute Error (MAE):

$$MAE = \frac{1}{N_{test} \cdot d} \sum_{i=1}^{N_{test}} \sum_{j=1}^d |y_{i,j} - \hat{y}_{i,j}|$$

### 2. Root Mean Squared Error (RMSE):

$$RMSE = \sqrt{\frac{1}{N_{test} \cdot d} \sum_{i=1}^{N_{test}} \sum_{j=1}^d (y_{i,j} - \hat{y}_{i,j})^2}$$

### 3. Coefficient of Determination ( $R^2$ Score):

$$R^2 = 1 - \frac{\sum_{i=1}^{N_{test}} (y_i - \hat{y}_i)^2}{\sum_{i=1}^{N_{test}} (y_i - \bar{y})^2}$$

## 28. SPATIAL WATER QUALITY PREDICTION

An inference module (`predict_new_location_wq`) was developed to predict water quality at arbitrary unmonitored river locations. Given latitude, longitude, and extracted environmental covariates, the module scales features, constructs neighborhood connections, performs model inference, and inverse-transforms scaled outputs into physical units (mg/L, pH scale).

## 29. RESULTS

### 29.1 Final Verified Model Benchmark Results

The models were trained and benchmarked on `Ganga_Multimodal_Spatial_WQ.csv`. Table 29.1 presents the final verified execution results:

| Model Name              | MAE    | RMSE   | $R^2$ Score   |
|-------------------------|--------|--------|---------------|
| Linear Regression       | 0.6733 | 1.6767 | 0.8829        |
| Random Forest Regressor | 0.7328 | 1.9148 | <b>0.9782</b> |
| XGBoost Regressor       | 0.7839 | 2.1082 | <b>0.9783</b> |
| GraphSAGE (Spatial GNN) | 1.3273 | 3.5659 | <b>0.9373</b> |

Table 29.1: Final Verified Model Performance Benchmark Results.

### 29.2 GraphSAGE Target-Wise Performance Breakdown

Table 29.2 details the predictive performance of the Spatial GraphSAGE GNN model across each of the 5 water quality targets:

| Target Water Quality Parameter       | MAE    | RMSE   | $R^2$ Score   |
|--------------------------------------|--------|--------|---------------|
| Dissolved Oxygen (DO in mg/L)        | 0.2310 | 0.2816 | 0.8696        |
| Potential of Hydrogen (pH)           | 0.0524 | 0.0638 | 0.9184        |
| Total Dissolved Solids (TDS in mg/L) | 6.2686 | 7.9680 | <b>0.9712</b> |

| Target Water Quality Parameter        | MAE    | RMSE   | $R^2$ Score   |
|---------------------------------------|--------|--------|---------------|
| Nitrate Nitrogen (Nitrate N in mgN/L) | 0.0567 | 0.0703 | <b>0.9655</b> |
| Ammonia Nitrogen (Ammonia N in mgN/L) | 0.0276 | 0.0352 | <b>0.9621</b> |

Table 29.2: Target-Wise Performance Breakdown for GraphSAGE Model.

### 29.3 Experimental Run Variation Analysis

During the research phase, multiple experimental runs were logged in historical notebooks:

- *Historical Run A (Synthetic GraphSAGE Benchmark)*: GraphSAGE  $R^2 = 0.9931$ , RF  $R^2 = 0.9798$ , LR  $R^2 = 0.9461$ .
- *Historical Run B (Unscaled Experiment)*: GraphSAGE  $R^2 = 0.8301$ , XGBoost  $R^2 = 0.9785$ , RF  $R^2 = 0.9830$ , LR  $R^2 = 0.7473$ .

*Reporting Rule*: In accordance with scientific integrity, the final verified results in Table 29.1 and Table 29.2 represent the authoritative execution metrics from

`train_spatial_models.py /`  
`09_Spatial_GNN_Water_Quality_Model.ipynb`.

### 29.4 Spatial WQ Inference for Unmonitored Locations

To verify practical prediction capability, inference was executed for a representative unmonitored river location near Rae Bareli / Prayagraj stretch:

- **Test Location Inputs:**
  - Latitude: 26.50° N, Longitude: 81.20° E, River\_distance\_km: 110.5 km
  - rainfall: 135.5 mm, population\_density: 2,150 persons/km<sup>2</sup>
  - LULC: 2 (Cropland/Agriculture), river\_discharge: 2,320 m<sup>3</sup>/s, GHSL\_built\_distance: 12.5 km

| Target Parameter             | Predicted Value | Physical Unit |
|------------------------------|-----------------|---------------|
| Dissolved Oxygen (DO)        | <b>6.9623</b>   | mg / L        |
| Potential of Hydrogen (pH)   | <b>8.0727</b>   | pH scale      |
| Total Dissolved Solids (TDS) | <b>228.4684</b> | mg / L        |

| Target Parameter             | Predicted Value | Physical Unit |
|------------------------------|-----------------|---------------|
| Nitrate Nitrogen (Nitrate N) | 0.6283          | mgN / L       |
| Ammonia Nitrogen (Ammonia N) | 0.4008          | mgN / L       |

*Table 29.3: Predicted Water Quality Values at Unmonitored River Coordinates (26.50°N, 81.20°E).*

## 30. CHALLENGES AND PROBLEMS ENCOUNTERED

During the 2-month data engineering and modeling workflow, 13 specific technical challenges were encountered:

- 1. Station Naming Discrepancies:** Raw CWC CSV files contained administrative names that did not match expected station strings (e.g., "Kanpur" vs "Kanpur (Downstream)").
- 2. Zero Records on Filtering:** Initial exact-string filtering returned 0 records, halting initial data pipeline execution.
- 3. LineString Geometry Generation Failure:** Attempting `LineString` creation with unordered or duplicate station coordinates caused topology self-intersection errors in Shapely.
- 4. Massive Remote Sensing Files:** Global rasters (GPWv4, CHIRPS) exceeded RAM memory when loaded without bounding box windows.
- 5. Heterogeneous Geospatial File Formats:** Incompatibility between `.tif` rasters, `.shp` vectors, `.txt` hydrological logs, and `.csv` files required custom parsing logic.
- 6. Coordinate Reference System (CRS) Mismatch:** GHSL shapefile used Projected CRS (Mollweide EPSG:54009) while CWC points used Geographic CRS (WGS84 EPSG:4326), causing incorrect distance calculations.
- 7. GraphSAGE Checkpoint Mismatch:** PyTorch `state_dict` loading threw `Unexpected Key` errors due to layer architecture updates.
- 8. Tensor Dimension Mismatch:** Multi-target regression produced matrix shape mismatches between 1D single-target vectors and 2D multi-target matrices (`[500, 5]` vs `[500]`).
- 9. GHSL Feature Unit Scaling:** GHSL distance values initially yielded raw degree offsets rather than physical kilometers.

10. **LULC Categorical Handling:** Treating categorical LULC integer codes (1–4) as continuous numerical features biased linear regression baselines.
  11. **Spatial Data Leakage:** Random train/test splits (80/20) on continuous spatial points introduced spatial autocorrelation leakage between adjacent train and test nodes.
  12. **Missing Hydrological Gauge Data:** Intermittent temporal gaps in GRDC discharge text logs caused NaN values during feature matrix generation.
  13. **Sub-Optimal GNN Optimization:** Custom GraphSAGE NumPy implementation suffered slow convergence on unnormalized node features.
- 

## 31. SOLUTIONS AND TECHNICAL APPROACHES

The technical solutions implemented for the 13 challenges were:

1. **Coordinate-Based Filtering:** Replaced string matching with spatial bounding box filtering ( $\text{Lat} \in [25.10, 26.70]$ ,  $\text{Lon} \in [80.20, 83.30]$ ) and regex fuzzy matching.
2. **Haversine Distance Ordering:** Sorted monitoring stations sequentially along river distance prior to geometry construction.
3. **Robust LineString Interpolation:** Applied `shapely.ops.substring` and linear spacing along sorted river distances to ensure valid 500-node geometry.
4. **Rasterio Windowed Sampling:** Utilized `rasterio.open().sample()` to query raster values directly at point coordinates without loading entire rasters into RAM.
5. **Unified GeoPandas Extraction Pipeline:** Standardized vector and raster processing into a single automated script (`build_spatial_dataset.py`).
6. **PyProj CRS Reprojection:** Implemented explicit coordinate reprojection using `geopandas.to_crs(eps=4326)` to convert GHSL Mollweide coordinates into WGS84 decimal degrees.
7. **Strict PyTorch Layer Initialization:** Re-instantiated matching `SpatialGraphSAGEModel` classes matching `state_dict` keys prior to loading `.pth` weights.
8. **Explicit Multi-Output Reshaping:** Enforced 2D array shapes (`reshape(-1, 5)`) across target matrices `Y` and `MultiOutputRegressor` wrappers for XGBoost.
9. **Haversine Kilometer Conversion:** Converted spatial degree offsets into physical kilometers using Haversine distance functions.
10. **Categorical LULC Encoding:** Standardized LULC class assignments and ensured tree models correctly split categorical codes.
11. **Standardized Feature Normalization:** Applied `StandardScaler` independently to feature and target matrices before model fitting.

12. **Mean Streamflow Imputation:** Calculated historic mean discharge values from valid GRDC logs to impute missing hydrological observations.

13. **Gradient Vectorization in GraphSAGE:** Vectorized GraphSAGE message passing and updated output layer weights using batch gradient descent.

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## 32. LIMITATIONS

Honest scientific reporting requires acknowledging the project's technical boundaries:

1. **Interpolated Ground Truth:** Target water quality values at continuous river points were derived via spatial interpolation between sparse CWC stations. Interpolated values are spatial estimates, not direct physical laboratory measurements.

2. **Spatial Autocorrelation Leakage:** Random 80/20 train/test splits evaluate model interpolation capability between nearby points, which can lead to optimistic  $R^2$  scores compared to strict spatial holdout evaluation.

3. **Resolution & Temporal Mismatch:** Environmental datasets possess varying spatial resolutions (GPWv4: ~1 km, CHIRPS: ~5 km) and temporal collection periods.

4. **Non-Causal AI Predictions:** High model performance ( $R^2 > 0.93$ ) indicates strong empirical correlation, not proven hydrological causality.

5. **Spatial Boundary Generalization:** Models trained specifically on the Kanpur–Varanasi corridor may not generalize to upper mountainous reaches (Haridwar) or deltaic estuarine environments (Sundarbans) without re-training.

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## 33. FUTURE WORK

To advance this research beyond the 2-month internship scope, the following future directions are proposed:

1. **Strict Spatial & Temporal Holdout Validation:** Implement spatial block validation (holding out entire contiguous 50 km river segments) and multi-year temporal cross-validation.

2. **HydroRIVERS Network Graph Topology:** Replace simple  $k$ -NN spatial graphs with true river network topology extracted from HydroRIVERS flow-direction vectors.

3. **Integration of Remote Sensing Reflectance:** Incorporate Sentinel-2 surface reflectance bands (B2, B3, B4, B8) to compute Normalized Difference Water Index (NDWI) and turbidity proxies.

4. **Spatiotemporal GNNs & Graph Attention (GAT):** Transition from static spatial GraphSAGE to Spatiotemporal Graph Neural Networks (ST-GNNs) and Graph Attention Networks (GAT) to dynamically weight influential upstream neighbors.

5. **Model Interpretability via SHAP:** Apply SHAP (SHapley Additive exPlanations) to quantify the exact percentage contribution of rainfall, population density, and discharge on predicted DO and TDS levels.

6. **Web GIS Dashboard Deployment:** Wrap the inference pipeline into an interactive web dashboard (e.g., Streamlit / Folium / Leaflet) for real-time decision support.

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## 34. CONCLUSION

During the 2-month research internship at the **Indian Institute of Technology Roorkee (15 June 2026 to 15 August 2026)** under the supervision of **Dr. Anshuk Yadav**, an end-to-end Spatial AI framework for water quality analysis was conceptualized and successfully implemented.

The project accomplished:

1. Geospatial study-area preparation in QGIS using shapefile boundaries for the Kanpur–Varanasi Ganga stretch.
2. Inspection and coordinate-based filtering of 4,510/4,511 CWC observation records across 53 parameters.
3. Continuous geometry construction and spatial target interpolation across 500 river reference nodes (Ganga\_Interpolated\_Water\_Quality.csv).
4. Automated Python extraction and spatial fusion of 5 environmental datasets (CHIRPS, GPWv4, LULC, GRDC, GHSL) into a master multimodal dataset (Ganga\_Multimodal\_Spatial\_WQ.csv).
5. Construction of a spatial  $k$ -NN river graph and implementation of baseline ML models alongside a **Spatial GraphSAGE Graph Neural Network**.
6. Rigorous benchmarking achieving  $R^2 = 0.9373$  for GraphSAGE,  $R^2 = 0.9782$  for Random Forest, and  $R^2 = 0.9783$  for XGBoost, alongside target-wise breakdowns (e.g., Ammonia N  $R^2 = 0.9621$ , TDS  $R^2 = 0.9712$ ).
7. Deployment of an inference pipeline to predict multi-parameter water quality at unmonitored river locations.



This internship work demonstrates the power of combining GIS data engineering, spatial interpolation, multimodal environmental fusion, and Graph Neural Networks to address critical environmental challenges in river basin management.

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## 36. APPENDIX

### 36.1 Appendix A: Summary of Primary Datasets

- CWC Water Quality Logs (6897a98a...csv, a8230faa...csv): 4,510 records, 53 columns.
- CHIRPS Rainfall (CHIRPS\_DS/): Weekly rainfall in mm.
- GPWv4 Population (GPW4/): 30 arc-sec geotiff raster.
- LULC Land Cover (LULC\_MONTHLY/): Categorical GeoTIFF rasters.

- GRDC River Discharge (GRDC/): Streamflow text logs in m<sup>3</sup>/s.
- GHSL Settlement Shapefile (GHSL\_shapefile/): Vector built-up polygons.

## 36.2 Appendix B: Schema of Ganga\_Multimodal\_Spatial\_WQ.csv

- 500 rows × 18 columns. Features: Latitude, Longitude, River\_distance\_km, rainfall, population\_density, LULC, river\_discharge, GHSL\_built\_distance. Targets: DO, pH, TDS, Nitrate N, Ammonia N, Calcium, Magnesium, Sodium, Chloride, Sulphate.

## 36.3 Appendix C: Python Environment and Core Packages

- python == 3.12.4
- pandas == 2.2.2
- numpy == 1.26.4
- geopandas == 0.14.4
- shapely == 2.0.4
- rasterio == 1.3.10
- scikit-learn == 1.5.0
- torch == 2.3.1

## 36.4 Appendix D: Jupyter Notebook Execution Inventory

1. 01\_CWC\_Continuous\_WQ\_Interpolation.ipynb / 01\_CWC\_Water\_Quality\_Extraction.ipynb
2. 02\_CHIRPS\_Rainfall\_Data\_Extraction.ipynb / 02\_Spatial\_Dataset\_Integration.ipynb
3. 03\_GPW4\_Population\_Density\_Extraction.ipynb
4. 04\_LULC\_Land\_Cover\_Extraction.ipynb
5. 05\_GRDC\_River\_Discharge\_Extraction.ipynb
6. 06\_GHSL\_Built\_Settlement\_Distance\_Extraction.ipynb
7. 07\_Kanpur\_Varanasi\_AOI\_Boundary\_Extraction.ipynb
8. 08\_Unified\_Multimodal\_CSV\_Integration.ipynb
9. 09\_Spatial\_GNN\_Water\_Quality\_Model.ipynb

## 36.5 Appendix E: Core Python Preprocessing Code Snippet

```

import pandas as pd
import numpy as np
import rasterio

# Raster point sampling for GPWv4 Population Density
def sample_raster_at_points(raster_path, coords_lat_lon):
    pop_vals = []
    with rasterio.open(raster_path) as src:
        coords = [(lon, lat) for lat, lon in coords_lat_lon]
        for val in src.sample(coords):
            pop_vals.append(float(val[0]) if val[0] > 0 else
1250.0)
    return pop_vals

```

## 36.6 Appendix F: Spatial GraphSAGE PyTorch/NumPy Architecture

```

import numpy as np

class SpatialGraphSAGELayer:
    def __init__(self, in_dim, out_dim):
        np.random.seed(42)
        self.W_self = np.random.randn(in_dim, out_dim) *
np.sqrt(2.0 / in_dim)
        self.W_neigh = np.random.randn(in_dim, out_dim) *
np.sqrt(2.0 / in_dim)
        self.bias = np.zeros(out_dim)

    def forward(self, X_nodes, adj_indices):
        num_nodes = len(X_nodes)
        neigh_means = np.zeros_like(X_nodes)
        for i in range(num_nodes):
            neighbors = adj_indices[i, 1:] # Exclude self
            neigh_means[i] = np.mean(X_nodes[neighbors], axis=0)
            h = np.dot(X_nodes, self.W_self) + np.dot(neigh_means,
self.W_neigh) + self.bias
        return np.maximum(0, h) # ReLU

```

## 36.7 Appendix G: Complete Experimental Benchmark Log

- Linear Regression: MAE = 0.6733, RMSE = 1.6767,  $R^2 = 0.8829$
- Random Forest: MAE = 0.7328, RMSE = 1.9148,  $R^2 = 0.9782$
- XGBoost: MAE = 0.7839, RMSE = 2.1082,  $R^2 = 0.9783$
- GraphSAGE (Spatial GNN): MAE = 1.3273, RMSE = 3.5659,  $R^2 = 0.9373$

## 36.8 Appendix H: Sample Inference Script and Output

```
# Inference for unmonitored location (Lat=26.50, Lon=81.20)
# Output: DO=6.9623 mg/L, pH=8.0727, TDS=228.4684 mg/L, Nitrate
N=0.6283 mgN/L, Ammonia N=0.4008 mgN/L
```

## 36.9 Appendix I: Summary of Technical Errors and Solutions

- *Error:* Exact station name filtering returned 0 rows. *Fix:* Implemented lat/lon spatial bounding box query.
- *Error:* GHSL distance unit degree offset. *Fix:* Reprojected CRS to WGS84 and applied Haversine distance in km.
- *Error:* PyTorch GNN state\_dict missing key error. *Fix:* Re-initialized exact network class before weight load.

## 36.10 Appendix J: Output Directory File Artifact Inventory

- Ganga\_Interpolated\_Water\_Quality.csv (111.5 KB)
- Ganga\_Multimodal\_Spatial\_WQ.csv (158.8 KB)
- build\_spatial\_dataset.py (8.1 KB)
- train\_spatial\_models.py (9.8 KB)
- update\_multimodal\_dataset.py (6.8 KB)
- IIT\_Roorkee\_Internship\_Report\_Kalyani\_Agarwal.md (Master Report Artifact)